



Engineering Journal

Blue Wave · Kuwait

1st

1st place with 61 points at the WRO Future Engineers 2026 Kuwait national round.
Next: the WRO 2026 Asia final in India.

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About this journal

Our engineering record for the WRO 2026 Asia final: what we built, why, how we tested it, and what went wrong on the way.

We built this journal from the pages in our repository: the five criterion pages in [docs/](#), [src/README.md](#), [Models/README.md](#) and [Vehicle_Photos/README.md](#). The numbers, dates and results here are the ones those pages give, and each chapter names the pages it draws on.

The repository is github.com/BllueWave/WRO-Future-Engineers-2026. The two competition sketches are [src/Open_Challenge/Open_Challenge.ino](#) (283 lines) and [src/Obstacle_Challenge/Obstacle_Challenge.ino](#) (1,103 lines).

Rule numbers and page numbers such as *rule 11.1 (p.23)* refer to the WRO Future Engineers 2026 rules.

Label	What it means
MAT	Seen on our real car, on a practice mat or at the national round.
SIMULATION	From <code>real2</code> , our simulator. It is harsher than the real car, so we use its numbers only to compare code versions.
BUILD	Compiler output from the Arduino IDE toolchain.
RULE	A requirement in the 2026 rules.
TEAM	Measured or recorded by the team on the car.

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Criterion and repository page	Chapters
1. Mobility	Chapters 1 and 2
2. Power and sensors	Chapter 2, Appendix A
3. Software and obstacle strategy	Chapter 3
4. Systems thinking and decisions	Chapters 2, 3, 5 and 6
5. Reproducibility	Chapter 4, Appendix B

01 Goals and constraints

The rules fixed the size of the car, how it steers, how it starts and what its sensors have to see. Our own parts added limits of their own: flash, RAM, pins and the camera's view.

Sources: [Mobility](#) · [Engineering decisions: constraints](#) · [Software and strategy](#) · [Arena page](#)

1.1 What the car has to do

Open Challenge

Three laps of the track with no pillars, then a stop in the start section. The corridors are 600 or 1000 mm wide (p.11), drawn at random before the round. Our full score for a round is three laps and a stop in the start section, 30 of 30. Three laps with a stop outside the start section give 27 points.

The field sets the geometry the sensors work in: walls 100 mm high, pillars 50 × 50 × 100 mm, and a racetrack 3000 × 3000 mm inside the walls. We built a model of the field to the 2026 rulebook, so we could look at a legal random draw before testing a strategy on the mat.

Obstacle Challenge

We start inside the parking lot for 7 points (item 1.8.1, p.21), drive three laps in 1000 mm corridors past red and green pillars, then park. Red means keep to the right of the lane and green to the left (p.6). A full parallel park gives 15 points and a partial one 7 (items 1.8.2 and 1.8.3, p.21).

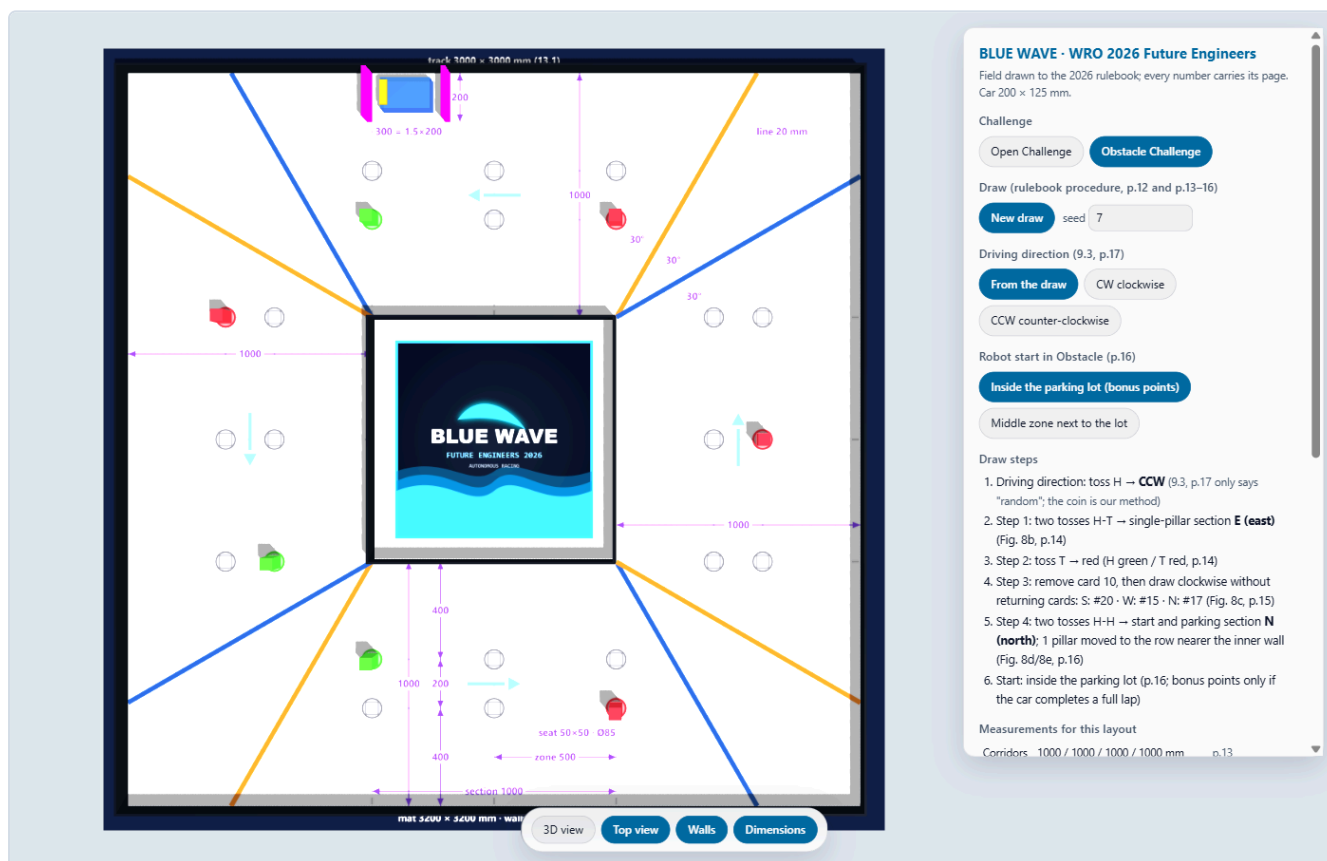


Figure 1. Our arena page, drawn to the 2026 rulebook. An Obstacle Challenge draw, seed 7: counter-clockwise, parking lot in the north straight, 4 red and 3 green pillars. The page draws the field and checks our 200 × 125 mm footprint against the start zone and the 300 mm lot. It does not simulate driving and it is not a test result.

1.2 Rules that shaped the design

Rule	What it asks	What we built
11.1, 11.2 (p.23)	At most 300 × 200 × 300 mm and 1.5 kg	A car of 200 × 125 mm: 100 mm shorter and 75 mm narrower than the limit
11.3, 11.5 (p.23); note on p.5	Four wheels, one steering actuator, no motor per side; the drive wheels physically connected	A 1:28-class RC chassis: one motor through the chassis gearbox, one servo on an Ackermann linkage
Parking lot (p.8)	1.5 × the car length long and 200 mm wide	A 300 mm lot for our car: 50 mm at each end and 75 mm across when centred
Open corridors (p.11)	600 or 1000 mm wide	At 125 mm wide the car leaves 475 mm of free width in a 600 mm corridor
13.4, 13.6 (p.26)	Black walls	HC-SR04 sonars, which time an echo of sound whatever the colour or the light
13.21, 13.22, 13.27	Red and green pillars, magenta parking limiters	Pixy2 signatures 1 red, 2 green, 3 magenta
9.10, 9.11, 9.14 (p.17)	One switch turns the car on; it then waits for one start button; pressing it starts the round	One main power switch; a start input on A2; <code>#define PRACTICE 0</code> in both sketches
9.9 (p.17), 13.18 (p.27)	No sensor calibration in preparation time; testing rounds for tuning to the venue colours	All calibration and Pixy2 training done in practice time

1.3 Limits from our own parts

Constraint	Number	Effect on the design
Flash	32,256 B on the Uno	The Obstacle sketch uses 29,604 B (91 %). A new feature must fit, or replace debug print text
RAM	2,048 B	Obstacle globals use 818 B. A 316 × 208 camera frame (65,728 px) could never fit, so the Pixy2 sends block lists
PWM pins	6 on the Uno, 5 taken by sonars, the servo timer and SPI	One motor channel, on D3
Camera view	60 degrees horizontal	The first pillar after a corner can be out of view
Side sonar geometry	About 40 degrees from the nose	Only a bearing-free law (left minus right) works; corner ties need a vote
Toolchain	We upload from the Arduino IDE	One <code>.ino</code> per challenge; sizes checked with the IDE's own compiler
Time	The v20 sketches were finished on 15 Sep 2026	Software changes come first; a hardware change such as a rear sonar needs its own test time on the mat

02 Hardware decisions

For each main part: why we chose it, and the trade-off we accepted with it. Many of those trade-offs show up again in the code.

Sources: [Mobility](#) · [Power and sensors](#) · [Engineering decisions: why we chose these parts](#) · [Models](#) · [Vehicle photos](#)



Figure 2. The car we race, with the body and every sensor fitted. *Left:* left corner HC-SR04 (D4/D5) and the Pixy2 bracket over the nose; the Uno's USB-B port is reachable through an opening in the side of the body, so sketches upload with the body on. *Right:* right corner HC-SR04 (D2/D9) and the Pixy2 ribbon cable; the chassis gear train shows under the body. *Front:* Pixy2 on its bracket above the nose, the front HC-SR04 (A0/D7) straight ahead, the two corner units at about 40° from the axis. *Back:* the main power switch in the rear vents; the Cytron MD13S under the rear of the body. *Bottom:* chassis plate with the drive motor in the centre and the Ackermann steering knuckles at the front.

The car at a glance

Size	About 200 × 125 mm (limit 300 × 200 × 300 mm, 1.5 kg)	Distance	3 × HC-SR04: one straight ahead, one on each nose corner at about 40°
Chassis	WLtoys 1:28-class RC chassis, four wheels, Ackermann front axle	Heading	BNO055 IMU on I2C (A4, A5)
Controller	Arduino Uno R3: 32,256 B flash, 2,048 B RAM	Camera	Pixy2 on SPI (ICSP): signature 1 red, 2 green, 3 magenta
Drive	One brushed DC motor on a Cytron MD13S (PWM D3, DIR D8); race setting PWM 30, about 1 m/s	Power	Battery 1 for the MD13S; battery 2 through the main switch to the Uno's VIN
Steering	Servo on D10; 30-160 while driving, 10 and 170 when parking	Start	Waits for the start switch on A2 after power-on

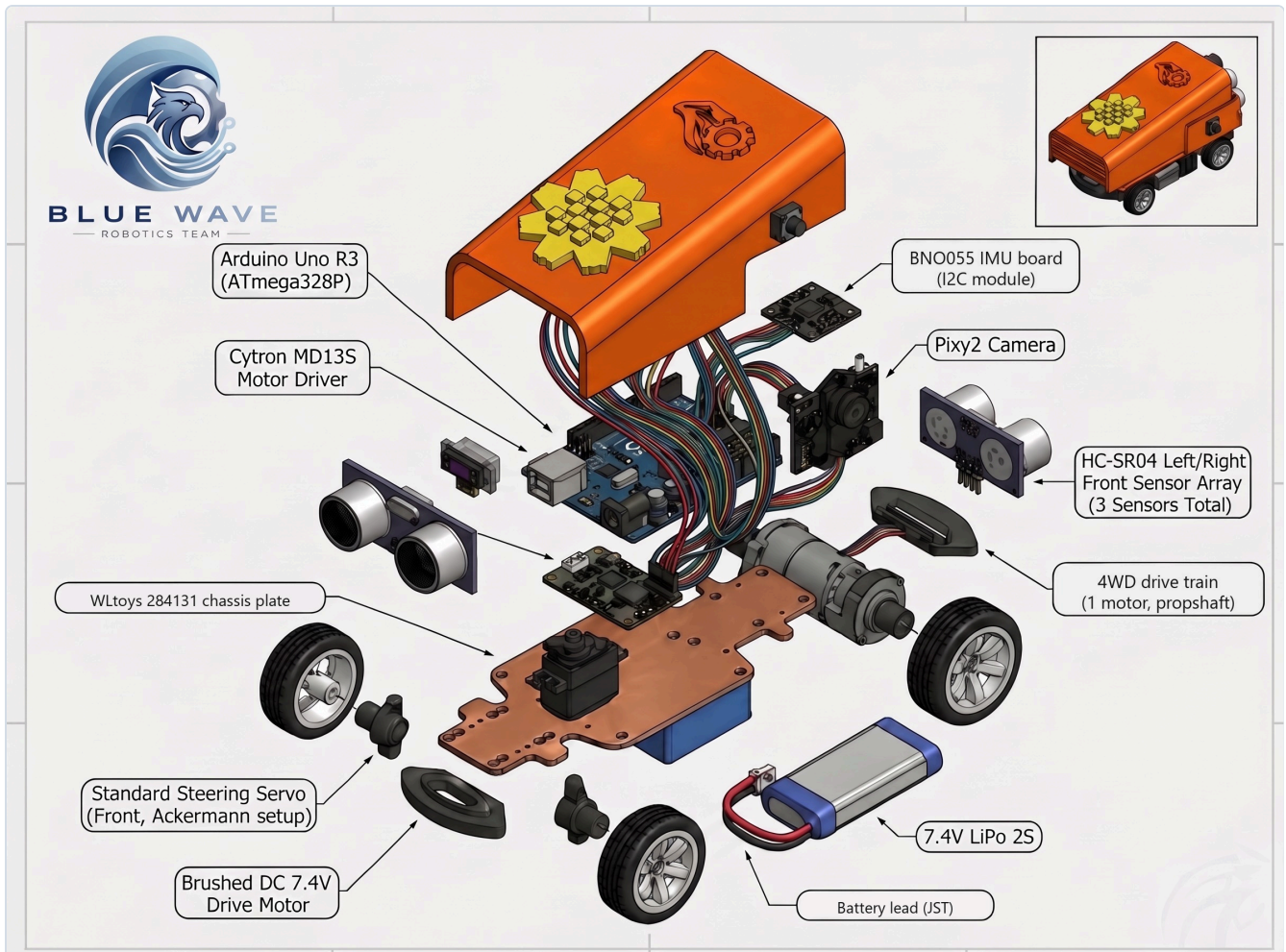


Figure 3. Exploded view of our car. This is an illustration, not a photograph and not a CAD export. The car runs on the four wheels of its chassis. For part names, sizes, sensor angles and the power wiring, the photos, the text and the diagrams in this journal are the reference.

2.1 Chassis, drive and steering

WLtoys 1:28-class RC chassis

four wheels, gearbox, Ackermann steering linkage

WHY WE CHOSE IT

- **Size.** 200 × 125 mm is inside the 300 × 200 mm limit, and the car fits its 300 mm lot with 50 mm to spare at each end.
- **Rules.** Four wheels, front Ackermann steering moved by one servo, and one motor through the chassis gearbox meet rules 11.3 and 11.5.
- **Time.** Wheels, gearbox and steering linkage came built. Our work went into the printed body, the sensors and the code.

TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED

- The brushed motor needs PWM 25 to start from rest: PWM 15 does not move the car and 18 only creeps. The code adds a 70 ms kick at PWM 55.
- The chassis has no wheel encoder. The park measures its step length with the front sonar and closes every arc on the IMU heading.

The lot end clearance is always $(1.5 L - L) / 2 = 0.25 L$. Because the lot grows with the car's length, a shorter car gains no end clearance. Only width changes the side clearance: at 125 mm the car fills 62.5 % of the 200 mm depth.

Speed

`analogWrite` is 8-bit, so our race setting PWM 30 is $30 / 255 = 11.8\%$ duty. Our speed anchor is a real run: the car drove the three Open laps in about 23 s with `open_kuwait` at PWM 30, timed with a stopwatch `MAT`. Our simulator had assumed 520 mm/s at PWM 30 and predicted 40-48 s. Refitted to the real run it gives about 998 mm/s, band 867-1176 mm/s. As a rough check, a lap along the centre line of 1000 mm corridors is 8 m, and three laps in 23 s is 1.04 m/s.

Running the whole Open round at PWM 37 finished in about 20 s but succeeded in 28 of 40 simulated rounds, against 34 of 40 at PWM 30 **SIMULATION**. So the Open sketch goes up to PWM 38 only on straights that stayed calm in lap 1, and the Obstacle sketch runs PWM 36 only on straights that showed no pillar in lap 1.

Steering

Setting	Servo value	Where
Straight ahead	90; above 90 steers left, below 90 right	Both sketches
Driving limits	30-160: 70 degrees left, 60 right	<code>Obstacle_Challenge.ino</code> line 88
Front avoid	$90 + 70 \times \text{urgency left}$, $90 - 60 \times \text{urgency right}$	line 638
Pillar mode slew	At most 6 degrees per control loop	line 99
Parking full lock	10 (right) and 170 (left)	line 107

The rear-axle centre of an ideal Ackermann car follows a circle of radius $R = L / \tan \delta$. The park code uses $R = 170 \text{ mm}$ (`R_PARK_MM`) and models every arc about a point on the rear-axle line. At the nominal 50-degree entry an arc moves the rear axle $0.77 R$ along the lot and $0.36 R$ across it, 130 mm and 61 mm. Every 10 mm of error in R moves the end of that arc about 8 mm along and 4 mm across; the final heading does not change, because the arc is closed on the IMU.

2.2 Controller and motor driver

Arduino Uno R3 as the only controller ATmega328P, 16 MHz, 32,256 B flash, 2,048 B RAM	
WHY WE CHOSE IT - One Uno runs each challenge sketch in a fixed loop and starts the moment it is powered. - It uploads from the Arduino IDE in seconds. - It has a library for each part that needs one: Servo, Adafruit BNO055 over Wire, NewPing and Pixy2.	TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED - Our Obstacle sketch uses 29,604 of 32,256 B of flash (91 %). - With 2,048 B of RAM the camera must send block lists, not images. - The Servo library takes Timer1, which leaves D3 as the one free PWM pin.
Cytron MD13S motor driver sign-magnitude: speed on PWM D3, direction on D8, DIR HIGH = forward	
WHY WE CHOSE IT - The Uno R3 has PWM on D3, D5, D6, D9, D10 and D11. When we chose the driver, D5, D6 and D9 were sonar lines, D11 is SPI MOSI for the Pixy2, and the Servo library disables <code>analogWrite</code> on D9 and D10. D3 was left. The front trigger has since moved from D6 to A0. - The MD13S needs exactly one PWM line and one digital line for one motor.	TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED - One motor channel only. A driver that takes speed on two PWM inputs would need a second PWM pin that we do not have. - Speed is set in 8-bit steps through <code>analogWrite</code>: the race setting PWM 30 is 11.8 % duty.

Every part and the link it uses are drawn together in the system overview in Appendix A.

2.3 Distance sensors and their placement

3 × HC-SR04 ultrasonic sensors

front A0/D7, left D4/D5, right D2/D9

WHY WE CHOSE THEM

- The walls are black. A sonar returns the distance to a black wall whatever the colour or the light in the hall.
- Each one uses two digital pins and reads whole centimetres up to 400 cm through NewPing.
- The front unit faces the wall ahead square on, which the 48 cm corner trigger, the Open finish and the park stop mark all use.

TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED

- Echoes return poorly at oblique angles: in a 1000 mm corridor the inner 40-degree unit often hears nothing, and the car rides 250-300 mm off the outer wall

SIMULATION

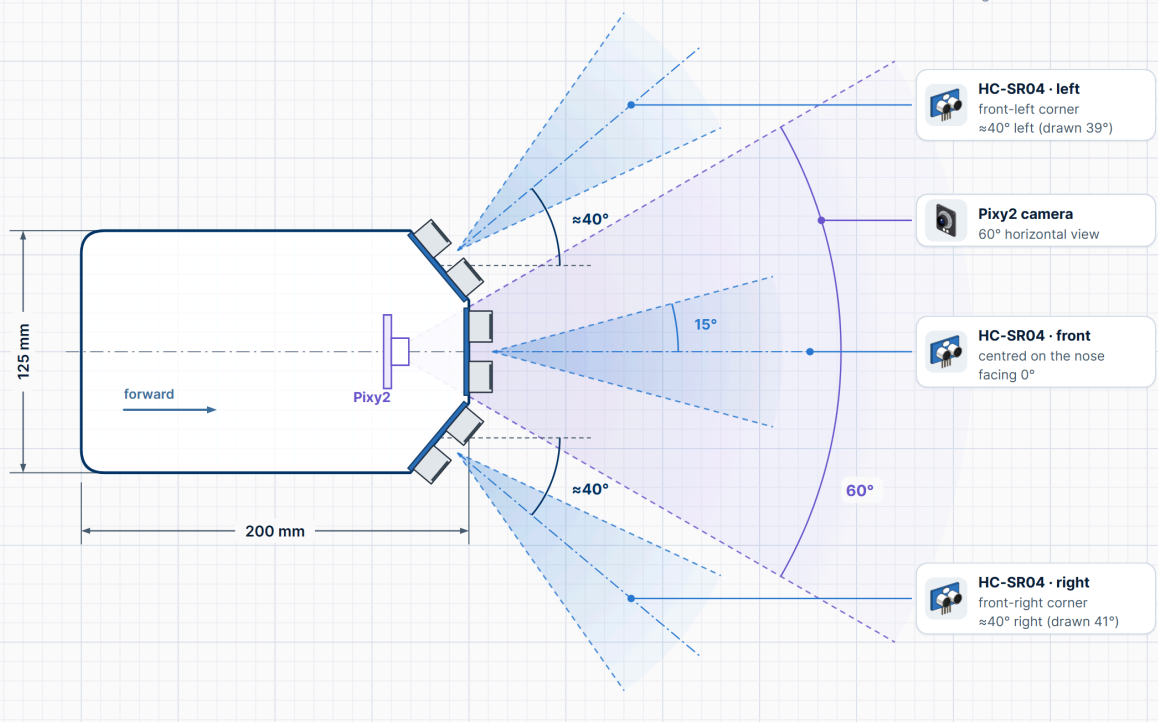
- A ping with no echo can wait about 23 ms.
- Nothing nearer than about 34 mm reads, so inside the parking bay the car steers on the IMU heading.

Sensor layout

Where the three HC-SR04 sonars and the Pixy2 look from, on a to-scale outline of the 200 × 125 mm car.

TOP VIEW · NOSE TO THE RIGHT

grid 10 mm · drawn to scale



LEGEND

- HC-SR04 beam, drawn at about 15° half-angle; cone length is not the range
- Pixy2 horizontal field of view, 60° (Pixy 2.0 datasheet)

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM

- 200 × 125 mm team figure, 14 Sep 2026
- ≈40° side sonars team drawing of the nose, 14 Sep 2026

Outline drawn to scale in code

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Sensor layout

Figure 4. Sensor layout, drawn to scale. The front sonar faces straight ahead; the side sonars sit on the slanted nose corners about 40 degrees from the axis (drawn at 39 and 41, from our drawing of the nose, 14 Sep 2026). The Pixy2 sees 60 degrees across.

What the 40-degree side sonars changed in the code

Each side sonar also sees part of the wall ahead. That changed the code in four places:

1. **Corner ties.** At the 48 cm front trigger both side units see the same front wall, so left minus right is close to zero and its sign flips from loop to loop. `open_kuwait` broke ties by turning right. The final code decides the turn from a vote of the corners already driven.

2. **Drift toward the outer wall** SIMULATION. The inner unit meets the wall at about 50 degrees incidence and often returns no echo. The code copies the other side's reading, the error becomes zero, and the car rides about 250-300 mm off the outer wall instead of centred.
3. **Late pillar sighting** SIMULATION. After a corner that drift puts the first pillar at a 55-65 degree bearing, outside the Pixy2's 30 degrees each side, until it is close.
4. **One parking fit per side** SIMULATION. Near a parallel wall a 40-degree unit returns the edge of its beam, not the axis, so the park keeps one linear fit per side: $mm = A \times cm + B$, A 5.16 / B 202.5 on the left and A 13.02 / B -50.2 on the right.

We kept the cant because our lane law does not depend on the bearing: a PD law on left minus right sees equal readings when the car is centred, at any sensor angle. Before we had a drawing of the nose, we had tuned laws in simulation for 90-degree flank sonars. On the real car those laws drove into the walls MAT.

HC-SR04 details we design around

Item	What it means for us
Minimum range	The module sends 8 cycles at 40 kHz, a 200 μ s burst. Sound covers 68.6 mm in that time, so an echo from nearer than about 34 mm returns while the burst is still going out.
Scale	NewPing converts at 57 μ s per cm. At 20 °C the round trip takes 58.3 μ s per cm, so readings are about 2.3 % long.
Timeout	A ping to the 400 cm limit can wait $400 \times 57 \mu s \approx 23$ ms for an echo that never comes.
Firing order	Left, right, front, one after another, with a 3 ms pause before each. Each ping waits for its echo or timeout.
Filter	$lpf = 0.9 \times new + 0.1 \times old$: 90 % of each new reading passes, so the lane error follows each reading closely.

2.4 Camera

Pixy2 camera		SPI through the ICSP header
WHY WE CHOSE IT - It finds the trained colour signatures on its own processor and sends only block records: signature, x, width and height. - The Uno never handles images. One 316 $\times$ 208 frame is 65,728 pixels; the Uno has 2,048 B of RAM. - A block's x gives the pillar's bearing and its size gives the range.		TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED - A 60-degree horizontal view: after a corner the first pillar can sit outside it until the car is close SIMULATION. - The signatures are trained again under each venue's light, in the testing time of rule 13.18.

Sig.	Trained on	Use in the finals code
1	Red pillar, RGB (238, 39, 55)	Pass on the pillar's right
2	Green pillar, RGB (68, 214, 44)	Pass on the pillar's left
3	Magenta limiter, RGB (255, 0, 255)	Declared as SIG_PARK_WALL ; skipped

A block in signature 1 or 2 is also rejected if it has the shape of a limiter: area of 600 px or more and width/height of 1.4 or more.

Bearing and range from the image. The range constants use a field of view of about 60 $\times$ 40 degrees on the 316 $\times$ 208 frame:

- bearing $\approx (x - 158) \times 0.19$ degrees;
- range = 13683 / width px or 28574 / height px for a 50 $\times$ 100 mm pillar, whichever is smaller.

In a simulator probe this range read about 5 % short straight ahead and up to 37 % short for a pillar 150-300 mm to the side SIMULATION. The front sonar may replace the camera range near the image centre, but only to make a pillar nearer.

2.5 IMU

BNO055 IMU		I2C on A4 (SDA) and A5 (SCL), address 0x28
WHY WE CHOSE IT - It fuses its sensors on its own chip and sends one heading over I2C. - That heading counts the 12 corners, ends the lot exit at 50 degrees, drives the U-turn guard and closes every park arc.	TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED <code>bno.begin()</code> with no argument selects NDOF mode, so the magnetometer is part of the fusion and a magnetic field can move the heading. The corner count keeps 20 degrees of margin for that. - A failed I2C read can show as a heading of exactly 0.0. The code keeps the previous heading and resets a stuck bus after 25 ms.	

The corner count adds each heading change, wrapped to ± 180 degrees, to a total that is never reset, and counts a corner when the total reaches $90 \times n + 70$ degrees. If the Obstacle exit turns 20 degrees or more the wrong way on the heading, the sketch flips `headingSign`, so an IMU mounted the other way up still counts the right way.

2.6 Two batteries

Separate motor and logic batteries		battery 1 for the motor, battery 2 for the Uno
WHAT THE SPLIT GIVES US Battery 1 (2S LiPo, 7.4 V nominal) connects straight to the Cytron MD13S power input and powers only the drive motor. Battery 2 goes through the main power switch to the Uno's VIN. The Uno's on-board regulator makes 5 V for the sensors and, through the ICSP header, the Pixy2. - The motor's current flows only between battery 1, the MD13S and the motor. The current dips it pulls on battery 1, including the 70 ms kick at PWM 55, never reach the Uno's supply.	TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPTED - Two packs to charge and check before every round. - A flat battery 2 resets the Uno even when battery 1 is full. <code>setup()</code> then sets the motor to 0 and the servo to 90 and waits for a new start input, so the round does not continue. - Battery 1 has no switch in its line, so the MD13S has power whenever battery 1 is connected. Its speed and direction come from the Uno on D3 and D8.	

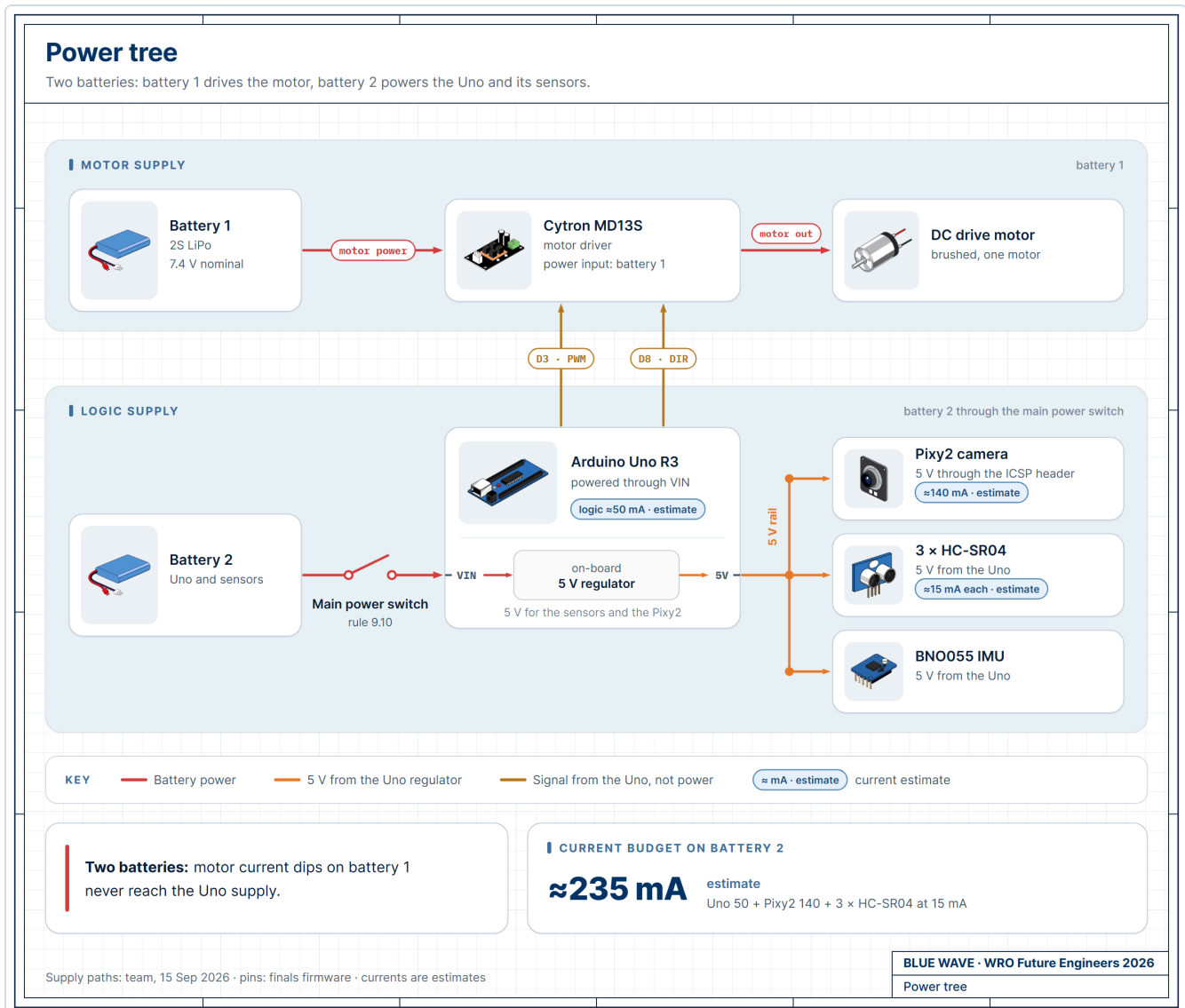


Figure 5. Power tree. Battery 1 feeds only the MD13S and the drive motor. Battery 2 feeds the Uno through the main power switch, and the sensors and the Pixy2 take 5 V from the Uno's regulator. D3 and D8 carry signals, not power.

Current through the Uno's regulator

Load	Current
Arduino Uno logic	about 50 mA
Pixy2, 5 V through ICSP	about 140 mA
3 × HC-SR04, while pinging	about 15 mA each
Uno, Pixy2 and three sonars	about 235 mA

Pixy2 and HC-SR04 figures from their datasheets; the Uno board figure is an estimate. Everything in this budget runs from battery 2; the drive motor has its own battery. The Pixy2 is about 60 % of the total.

Wiring rules we keep

- Motor current stays on battery 1 and never returns through the Uno header. Only signal ground goes to the Uno, as the reference for the PWM and DIR lines.
- We once connected a black lead near the Uno power header and got heat and a burnt component.
- After any wiring fault we measure the resistance from 5 V to GND with the power off before switching on again.
- One power switch and one start input, from A2 to GND with the internal pull-up (rules 9.10 and 9.11).

2.7 Printed body and brackets

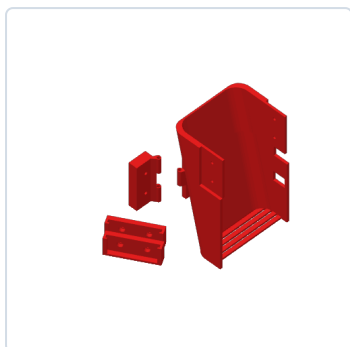


Figure 6. Plate preview stored in our print project. `Models/BlueWave_main_body_v2.3mf` is a Bambu Studio 02.01.01.52 project saved on 20 November 2025, with five parts on one plate. The raised "AUMers" lettering and the logo on this body are from AUMers, the name our club and team used before we competed as Blue Wave. The design is ours. The saved filament colour is red, and the car we race has an orange body.

Part in the file	Copies	Bounding box (mm)
Body shell	1	79.0 × 123.0 × 58.0
Ultrasonic sensor bracket	2	32.7 × 47.4 × 19.0
Ultrasonic and Pixy2 bracket	1	49.3 × 15.3 × 23.5
Pixy2 bracket	1	49.3 × 6.7 × 29.7

Print setting saved	Value
Printer	Bambu Lab X1 Carbon, 0.4 mm nozzle
Layers	0.24 mm, first layer 0.20 mm
Infill, walls	15 % grid; 2 loops
Supports	Tree (auto), 35° threshold
Filament	Generic PETG, nozzle 255 °C, plate 70 °C

The two ultrasonic brackets and the combined bracket give three ultrasonic mounts, the same count as the HC-SR04 sensors on the car.

03 Software development by version

From the June national-round code to the v20 finals sketches. Every row below is a problem we found, the change we made and what it did.

Sources: [Engineering decisions: version history](#) · [Software and strategy](#) · [Mobility: what changed since June](#) · [src/README.md](#)

3.1 Where the code started

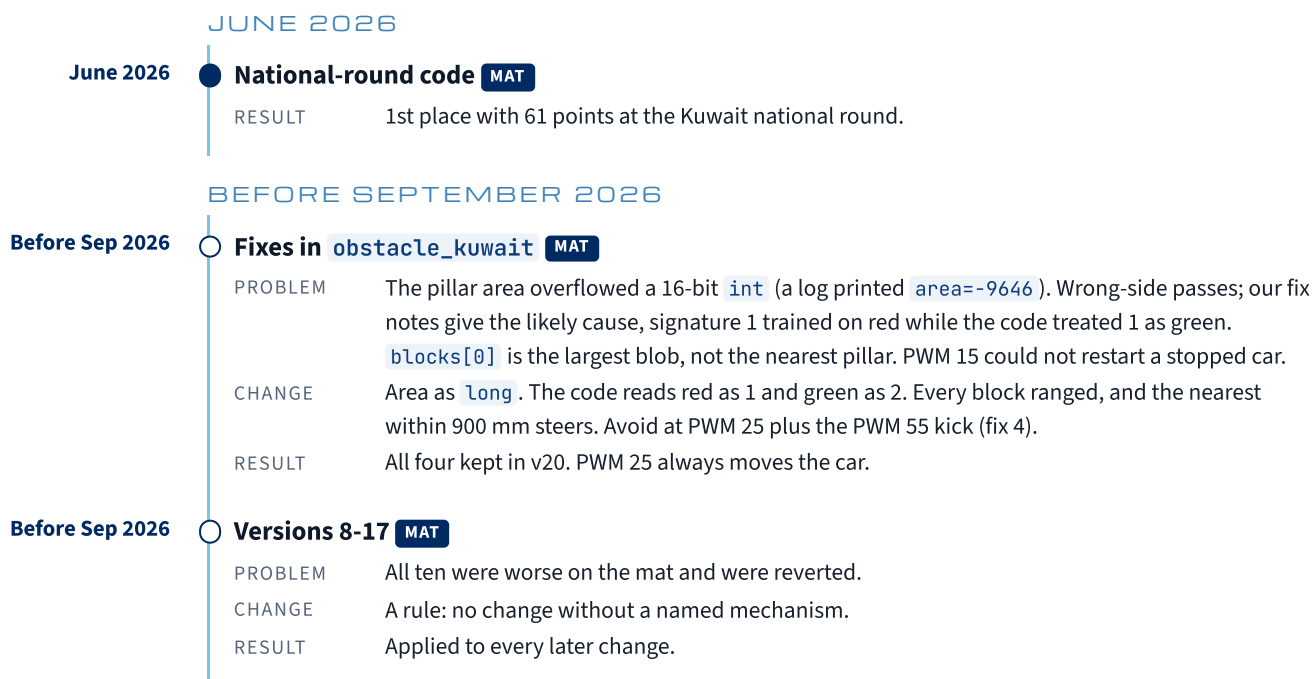
The June sketch in this repository (commit [87508ae](#); both challenge folders held the same file) and the finals sketches share the race speed PWM 30, the servo limits and the gains KP 0.6 and KD 0.05. They differ here:

Item	June sketch	Finals sketches
Corner trigger	<code>FRONT_AVOID_CM</code> 28	48
Avoid speed	<code>MOTOR_SPEED_AVOID</code> 20, no kick	25, plus the PWM 55 kick
Pillar ladder	One step: servo 140 for green, 40 for red	Three steps per colour: 140/120/102 and 40/60/78
Start	Drives on power-up	Waits for a change on A2
Lot exit and park	None	Ratchet exit, front-wall park

The finals sketches are built on [open_kuwait](#) and [obstacle_kuwait](#). Both already had the 48 cm trigger and PWM 25 with the kick. Only [obstacle_kuwait](#) had the three-step ladder; [open_kuwait](#) steered 140 or 40 on the largest Pixy2 block. Both drove off on power-up, and neither parked. The Obstacle sketch is built on the 6 September 2026 build, which is [obstacle_kuwait](#) plus fixes 15, 16 and 17.

3.2 Version history

This history comes from our firmware folders and dated notes. The work between the national round and the v20 sketches was done in our local workspace and committed to `main` in September 2026, with every commit keeping its original date.



Before Sep 2026

Parking versions 14-16 MAT

PROBLEM	Legs that ended on sensor readings stalled or hit the limiter.
CHANGE	Timed legs closed on the IMU heading.
RESULT	Became the park architecture.

SEPTEMBER 2026

2 Sep 2026 ● Car on `obstacle_kuwait`, per our notes MAT

RESULT	Three full Obstacle laps with one light touch on one pillar.
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6 Sep 2026 ○ 6 September parking build MAT

PROBLEM	The exit worked, but the car did not park: the lap total was zeroed while the car was 50 degrees rotated.
CHANGE	Fix 26: a total that is never reset, with the exit rotation seeded into it.
RESULT	Lap 3 can close and the park can arm.

11 Sep 2026 ○ Simulator SIMULATION

PROBLEM	The model car was 1.9 times too slow.
CHANGE	Speed refitted to the real 23 s Open run.
RESULT	All later simulator results use the fitted speed.

14 Sep 2026 ○ Team drawing of the nose MAT

PROBLEM	Laws tuned for 90-degree side sonars hit the walls.
CHANGE	Side units modelled at 39 and 41 degrees; only the left-minus-right law kept.
RESULT	The simulator uses the drawn geometry.

14 Sep 2026 ○ Finals build of that day MAT

PROBLEM	The car did not move: the start waited for a press then a release, the exit PWM was below 25, the park build fitted only with PlatformIO flags, and an IMU failure ended in a silent <code>while(1)</code> .
CHANGE	Start on any A2 change; IDE build; servo wiggle fault code.
RESULT	v20 keeps the start logic and the fault code and fits the IDE build. Its exit keeps PWM 18 from the 6 September build.

15 SEPTEMBER 2026: V20

15 Sep 2026 ○ `open_v20` SIMULATION

PROBLEM	Corner direction a coin toss; lap 3 sometimes closed at corner 13.
CHANGE	Corner vote; 12 counted corners, then a front-range stop.
RESULT	37/40 against 21/40 in simulation.

15 Sep 2026 ○ `obstacle_v20` SIMULATION

PROBLEM	The 6 September build never reached its park, had no start input, turned right on every tie and ended its round on a nose-on contact.
CHANGE	Front-wall park with a solved entry angle, lap-1 map, corner vote, stuck recovery, A2 start.
RESULT	Exit 119/120 and three laps 12/120 in simulation.

15 Sep 2026 ○ `src/` BUILD

PROBLEM	Rule 9.11.
CHANGE	<code>open_v20</code> and <code>obstacle_v20</code> committed as <code>Open_Challenge.ino</code> and <code>Obstacle_Challenge.ino</code> with <code>PRACTICE 0</code> ; nothing else changed.
RESULT	Compiles with the Arduino IDE compiler: 15,136 B and 29,604 B.

3.3 How both sketches run

Both sketches are single `.ino` files with no local libraries, because we upload from the Arduino IDE. Each is one `loop()` that runs top to bottom:

1. Sonars Ping left, right and front, a 3 ms pause before each	2. Heading Read the BNO055 over I2C and update the corner count	3. Camera Poll the Pixy2 over SPI	4. Decide Choose a servo angle and a motor PWM	5. Report Print one debug line at 115200 baud
--	---	---	--	---

Before the start the servo reports the IMU: one wiggle means ready, two wiggles repeating means the BNO055 did not answer and the car will not drive. `waitStart()` reads A2 with the internal pull-up and starts the round when the level has changed for 30 ms, so a push button and a toggle switch both work. With **PRACTICE 1** the car would also start 3 s after power-up, which we use only on a practice table; both sketches in `src/` have **PRACTICE 0**.

Open stays in that loop for the whole round. The Obstacle sketch runs the same loop inside a six-state machine, and its laps hand over to the park only when the car is parallel and clear of pillars, so the park starts from a known pose.

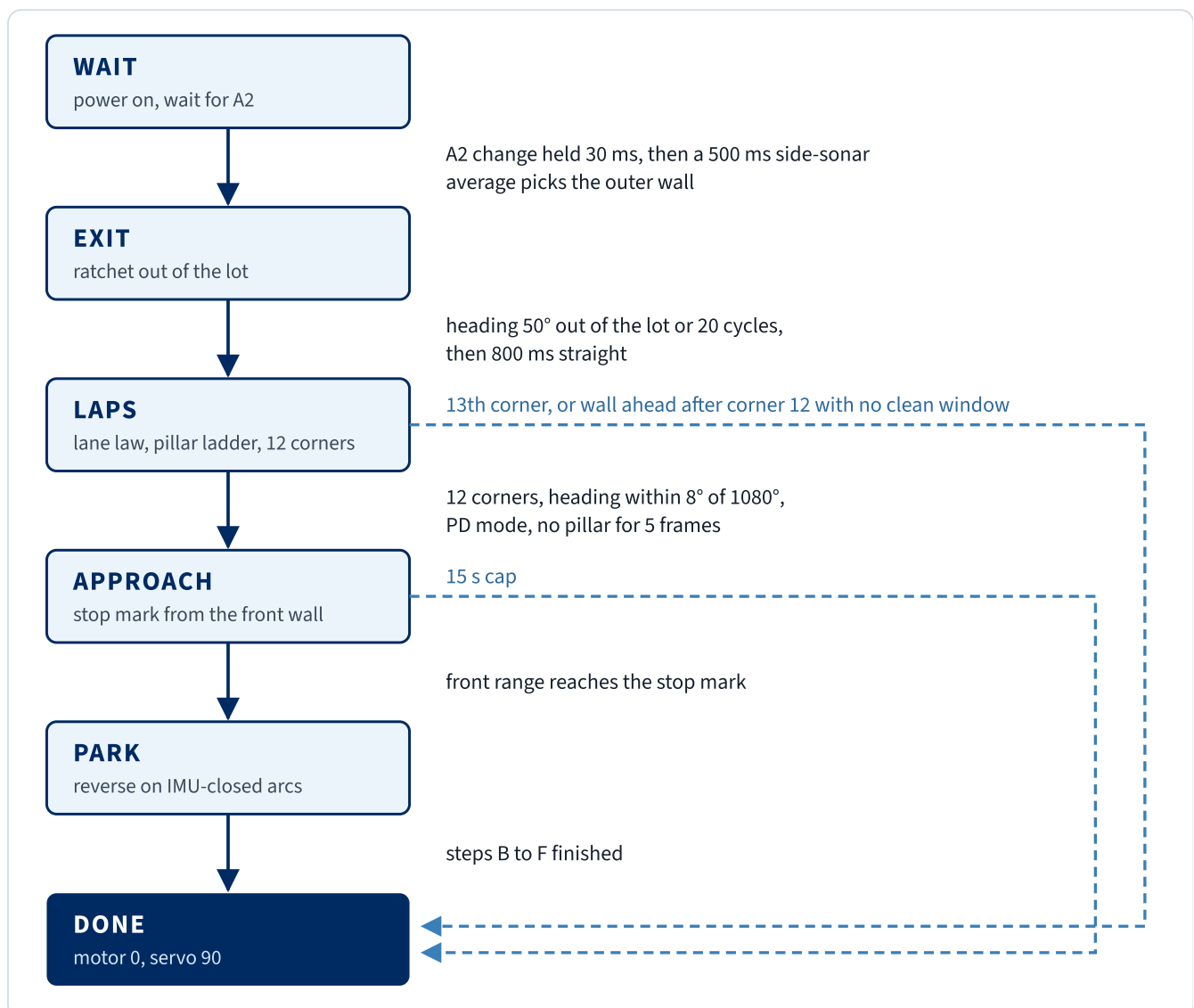


Figure 7. Obstacle sketch state machine. Solid arrows are the planned path through a round; dashed arrows are the two ways a round ends early. In DONE the motor stays at 0 and the servo at 90, and the car never starts a fourth lap.

3.4 What open_v20 does

Lane keeping. The error is $e = \text{left} - \text{right}$ in centimetres, after the filter. The servo command is $90 + 0.6 \cdot e + 0.05 \cdot \Delta e$, limited to 30-160. The integral gain is 0.

Corners. At 48 cm or less on the front sonar the car slows to PWM 25 and turns. Urgency = $(48 - \text{front}) / (48 - 18)$, clamped to 0.25-1, so the servo reaches full travel at 18 cm. The side is chosen in this order:

1. if left and right differ by more than 3 cm, the longer side;
2. otherwise the majority of the corners already counted;
3. before the first corner, the sign of a slow left-minus-right average, if it is at least 4 cm;
4. otherwise right.

A U-turn guard holds the servo straight once the car has turned 100 degrees inside one avoid.

Laps and the finish. Corner $n+1$ counts when the never-reset turn total reaches $90 \cdot n + 70$ degrees. After corner 12, once the front has read more than 180 cm twice (looking down the start straight), the car stops at the first two readings of 150 cm or less. A 700 ms backstop after corner 12 stops it anyway.

Faster straights. In lap 1 the car records the largest error on each straight, more than 700 ms after the corner with the front over 150 cm. In laps 2 and 3 a straight whose lap-1 maximum stayed under 25 cm runs at PWM 38 while the error is under 18 cm and the front reads over 150 cm. Every corner starts at PWM 30.

Stiction kick. Whenever the commanded PWM is above 0 and below 30, the motor gets PWM 55 for the first 70 ms, then 70 ms of PWM 55 every 500 ms.

Camera call. Open calls `pixy.ccc.getBlocks()` every loop and ignores the result, so each loop takes as long as it did in the `open_kuwait` runs on the mat.

3.5 What obstacle_v20 does

The six states are in the figure in section 3.3. This section follows one Obstacle round through them.

Start, outer-wall pick and lot exit

Standing still for 500 ms, the car averages both side sonars. The shorter side is the outer wall, which also seeds the corner vote with a weight of 2: outer wall on the left means the round is clockwise and the corners turn right. We place the car about 40 mm from the outer wall every time.

One exit ratchet cycle is: pause 220 ms with the wheels at full lock toward the wall, reverse 200 ms at PWM 18, pause 220 ms at the opposite lock, forward 200 ms at PWM 18. Cycles repeat until the heading is 50 degrees out or 20 cycles have run, then the car drives straight for 800 ms at PWM 18. These are the values of the 6 September build whose exit worked on the mat. The exit's rotation is carried into the turn total (fix 26).

Pillars

Each loop reads up to 8 Pixy2 blocks. A block counts as a pillar only if its signature is 1 or 2, it is not shaped like a limiter, its area is at least 200 px and its x is between 20 and 300. Only pillars within 900 mm steer the car. The nearest wins, and the colour lock switches only if the other pillar is at least 250 mm nearer.

Beyond 550 mm the servo target is pulled toward 90 by $k = (900 - \text{range}) / 350$, never below 0.35. Pillar mode starts after 2 good frames, if 280 ms have passed since the last change or the pillar is within 550 mm, and ends after 3 missed frames and 280 ms.

In pillar mode the servo slews at most 6 degrees per loop; a front reading of 25 cm or less snaps it to full travel on the target side; and if the side sonar toward the turn reads under 25 cm, the command is capped at $90 + (\text{target} - 90) \times (\text{side} - 16) / 9$, so the car cannot steer hard into a wall it is already close to.

Pillar	x in the 316 px frame	Servo target
Green	$x < 120$	140 (hard left)
Green	$120 \leq x < 170$	120
Green	$x \geq 170$	102 (soft left)
Red	$x > 200$	40 (hard right)
Red	$150 < x \leq 200$	60
Red	$x \leq 150$	78 (soft right)

Lap-1 map, scan weave and stuck recovery

- **Lap-1 map.** In lap 1 the car stores the colours of the first two pillars that put it into pillar mode on each straight. In laps 2 and 3, for up to 1.6 s after a corner and once the heading is within 12 degrees of the new straight, it moves the lane set-point 20 cm toward the side the first mapped pillar needs.
- **Scan weave.** With no pillar in view and $|L - R|$ under 6 cm, a ± 5 degree sine with a 1.3 s period sweeps the camera view across the frame edges.
- **Stuck recovery.** If the last front reading is 15 cm or less and the heading has not moved 3 degrees in 0.7 s, the car sets opposite lock and reverses: PWM 55 for 70 ms, PWM 30 for 450 ms, then stops for 120 ms.

Control priority inside `LapStep()` :

1 Park handover, or a stop if the park window is missed	2 Pillar mode, with the 25 cm full lock and the wall cap	3 Front avoid at 48 cm	4 Lane PD with map bias, scan weave, fast straights	5 Stiction kick on the chosen PWM	6 Stuck recovery, overriding the rest for 640 ms
---	--	----------------------------------	---	---	--

3.6 The front-wall park

After three laps the front HC-SR04 measures the wall at the end of the start straight at near-normal incidence. The car stops at a mark computed from that distance, then reverses into the lot on IMU-closed arcs and measured straight steps.

Why the front wall. We measured the distance from the far wall to the downstream limiter on a mat: about 1.0 m with the lot on the car's right and about 1.7 m with it on the left `TEAM`. That matches the rulebook. Inside the bay the side units are near their 34 mm minimum and lose the echo at oblique angles, and the camera faces away from the lot the car reverses into. So while the car manoeuvres, the IMU heading is the reading we trust.

The stop mark. $\text{mark} = \text{lot distance} - 200 - (-40)$. With `LOT_RIGHT_MM` 980 the mark is 820 mm for a lot on the right. The lot-left distance is $3000 - 340 - 980 = 1680$ mm, so that mark is 1520 mm. During the approach a far-wall tracker rejects echoes from the limiter tips, which read about 900 mm short of the wall.

B. Mark Step onto the mark within 30 mm; measure the real step length from four reverse steps	Solve Pose from front range, wall sonar and IMU; entry angle from 36-64°	C. Arc in Reverse arc at the wall-side lock, cut by the clearance model	D. Straight Straight reverse in steps, each checked first	E. Square Arc pairs of up to 6° until within 3° of parallel	F. Centre Centre on the downstream limiter; motor 0, servo 90
---	--	---	---	---	---

A step is 25 ms at PWM 55, 25 ms at PWM 22, then 380 ms to settle. Every arc runs at PWM 18 and is closed on the IMU heading; the motor is cut early by the turn rate $\times 150$ ms because the car keeps turning while it coasts, and arcs are capped at 2.6 s. Before each arc in C and E and each straight step in D, the 200×125 mm car outline is checked against both limiters and the wall with a 12 mm margin.

3.7 How we change the code

Our rule since versions 8-17: before we try a change we write down the input, the state, the computed value and the wrong action it fixes. In our simulator we compare the change against the previous version on the same seeds. On the mat a new sketch runs in practice time first.

KP 0.6 and KD 0.05 are unchanged from the June sketch, and the ladder thresholds ($\times 120$ and 170 for green, 150 and 200 for red) come from fix 8 in `obstacle_kuwait`. We kept them because the builds that carried them drove on the mat.

04 Testing method and results

Our mat results come from our earlier builds. Every v20 result comes from our simulator, and each one carries that label.

Sources: [Build, test and reproduce](#) · [Power and sensors: calibration procedures](#) · [Software and strategy: how we tune](#)

4.1 How we test

1. Bench The ten-minute bench check below, before every session	2. Simulation Seeded batches in <code>real2</code> , each change against the previous version on the same seeds	3. Replay Webots replays of selected simulated runs, to watch a failure in 3D	4. Mat New sketches in practice time first, with a fallback rule
---	---	---	--

A mat test of an Obstacle sketch is 20 runs from legal random starts. For each run we record the exit, laps, pillars touched and park result, and we report the success rate. In simulation we record per batch:

Metric	Open	Obstacle
Full score	3 laps and a stop in the start section (30/30)	Exit, 3 laps, park type
Where it failed	Wall crash, wrong direction, first corner, stop outside the section	Wrong-side pass, reversed, limiter, stuck
Quality	Lap-3 median time, wall grazes per run	Sections completed, grazes per run

Ten-minute bench check

Car on a stand with all four wheels off the table, both batteries charged and battery 1 connected to the MD13S, serial monitor at 115200 baud.

#	Check	Pass
1	Library versions on the upload laptop	Versions match Appendix B
2	Verify the sketch	Sizes match Appendix B; <code>#define PRACTICE 0</code>
3	Upload, then switch on with the main switch	One servo wiggle. Two wiggles repeating: BNO055 not answering, check A4/A5
4	Obstacle sketch: read the serial monitor	<code>WAIT L .. R .. F .. yaw ..</code> every 400 ms
5	Hand 20 cm in front of each sonar in turn; nose square to a wall at a taped 50 cm	<code>L</code> , <code>R</code> and <code>F</code> each change; <code>F</code> reads about 51
6	Turn the car clockwise by hand	<code>yaw</code> increases
7	Wait 5 s after power-on	Wheels do not turn
8	Change the A2 switch	Obstacle: <code>outer wall = LEFT/RIGHT</code> prints, then the servo alternates full locks. Open: the drive wheels turn
9	PixyMon with a red, a green and a magenta object at 900 mm	Boxes with signatures 1, 2 and 3
10	Voltage of battery 1 and battery 2 with a meter, written on the test sheet	Two numbers: battery 1 so speed results can be matched to charge, battery 2 because a flat battery 2 resets the Uno

Calibration checks in practice time

Check	How	Pass
Pixy2 signatures	In PixyMon, under the venue light: signature 1 on a red pillar, 2 on a green pillar, 3 on a magenta limiter	One box with the right signature at 900 mm
Pixy2 range	Pillar 500 mm straight ahead; read its width and height in PixyMon	About 27 px wide and 57 px tall, matching 13683 and 28574
IMU direction	Obstacle sketch waiting; turn the car clockwise by hand	<code>yaw</code> increases
Front range	Car square to a wall; tape from the nose	<code>F</code> matches the tape within about 3 %
Side sonars	Hand in front of each side unit	<code>L</code> and <code>R</code> change
Outer-wall pick	Car in the lot about 40 mm from the outer wall, facing the driving direction; start	Prints <code>outer wall = LEFT</code> or <code>RIGHT</code> , matching the real wall

Park constants and how to set them on a mat

Constant	Now	Procedure
<code>LOT_RIGHT_MM</code>	980	Tape from the far wall to the far face of the downstream limiter, lot on the car's right. <code>LOT_LEFT_MM</code> follows as $3000 - 340 - \text{LOT_RIGHT_MM}$
<code>R_PARK_MM</code>	170	Servo at 170, push the car slowly through a full circle, mark the rear-axle centre, halve the diameter. Repeat at servo 10
<code>SIDE_A_L</code> , <code>SIDE_B_L</code> , <code>SIDE_A_R</code> , <code>SIDE_B_R</code>	5.16, 202.5, 13.02, -50.2	Car parallel to a wall with the rear axle 300 mm and then 400 mm from it; read that side's sonar in cm. $A = 100 / (\text{cm}400 - \text{cm}300)$, $B = 300 - A \times \text{cm}300$
<code>CAR_NOSE_MM</code>	168	Rear-axle centre to the front bumper, steel rule
<code>PARK_LANE_MM</code>	320	Rear axle to the outer wall during the approach; check that it clears the limiter tips at 200 mm

4.2 Results on the mat MAT

Date	Code	What happened
June 2026	National-round code	1st place, 61 points , Kuwait national round
Before Sep 2026	Motor test	PWM 15 does not start the car from rest, 18 creeps, 25 always moves it
2 Sep 2026	<code>obstacle_kuwait</code> , as listed in our notes	Three full Obstacle laps with one light touch on one pillar
6 Sep 2026	6 September parking build	Lot exit worked; our best Obstacle driving so far, with light scrapes; did not park (lap counter, fixed as fix 26)
By 11 Sep 2026	<code>open_kuwait</code> , PWM 30	Three Open laps in about 23 s
14 Sep 2026	Finals build of that day	The car did not move; four causes found and fixed (chapter 5)

4.3 Results in simulation SIMULATION

Read these numbers as comparisons. The simulator is harsher than the real car and passes one of its three fidelity gates. We use its numbers only to compare code versions against each other.

`real2` compiles the unchanged `.ino` with a PC compiler and runs it against a model of our car; only `while(1);` is rewritten, to a halt. The model has the 200×125 mm outline with side sonars at 39 and 41 degrees, HC-SR04 acoustics including a 38-60 ms hold when no echo returns, a Pixy2 at 60 frames per second, a BNO055 with drift and noise, the time cost of serial printing, tyre grip and wall contact. Each seed randomises the turning radius ($\pm 15\%$), speed ($\pm 12\%$), break-away (PWM 16-18), servo speed, start pose and sonar dropout.

Fidelity gates: does the model reproduce the real car?

Gate	Real car	Target	Simulator	Verdict
open_kuwait , 3 laps	Reliable	≥ 80 %	33/60 = 55 % (clockwise 77 %, counter-clockwise 24 %)	Fail
obstacle_kuwait , 3 laps, no pillar moved	Three laps, one light touch, 2 Sep 2026	≥ 60 %	1/60 = 2 %	Fail
6 September build, lot exit	Worked on 6 Sep 2026	≥ 80 %	58/60 = 97 %	Pass

Calibration F3, 60 seeds from 10,500,000. Both failed gates score below the real car, so the simulator is harsher than the car.

The v20 sketches

Sketch	Test	Result
Open v20	Paired with open_kuwait on the same seeds	37/40 against 21/40
Open v20	Final file, 40 fresh seeds from 9,100,000	36/40; lap-3 median 25.6 s; 0.1 wall grazes per run
Open v20	All 32 draw cells (16 corridor combinations × 2 directions), 320 runs	287/320 = 90 % scored 30/30; lap-3 median 26.0 s; 0.14 grazes per run
Open v20	Calibration F3, 60 seeds	55/60 = 92 %
Obstacle v20	60 lot starts from 9,200,000	Exit 60/60; three laps 1/60; endings: wrong-side pass 35, reversed 8, limiter 10
Obstacle v20	120 lot starts from 10,500,000, F3	Exit 119/120; three laps 12/120; of those, 3 partial parks and 0 full
Obstacle v20	Park only, from the lap-3 handover pose, 16 runs	4 full parks; limiter touched in about half

The 37/40 comes from the paired comparison during development; the final file on fresh seeds scored 36/40, and that is the number we quote for v20. The gap between 1/60 and 12/120 three-lap Obstacle rounds comes from the seed blocks, not from the calibration.

Where Open v20 fails: 33 of 320 runs

Failure	Runs
Wall crash mid-round	11
Wrong turn direction	8
At the first corner (5 stuck, 1 crash)	6
Three laps, stopped outside the start section	6
Other	2

Weakest corridor cells

Cell	Direction	Success
600-1000-1000-600	Counter-clockwise	7/11
600-1000-1000-1000	Clockwise	7/10
600-1000-600-1000	Counter-clockwise	8/11

Webots replays

Webots draws the rulebook field and moves the car along a path logged by [real2](#). It is a kinematic replay with no physics, and the verdict on screen is copied from our arena scorer. The seven v20 replays:

1. Open, clockwise (seed 7100007)
2. Open, counter-clockwise (seed 7100003)
3. Obstacle, three laps, no park, counter-clockwise (seed 6200015)
4. Obstacle, three laps, no park, clockwise (seed 6200035)
5. Obstacle, the typical failure: inner-row pillar right after a corner (seed 6100004)
6. Park only, full park, clockwise (seed 8100000)
7. Park only, partial park, counter-clockwise (seed 8100007)

05

Problems we met and how we fixed them

Each card is a problem recorded on our pages: what we saw, why it happened, and what we changed. Most came from the mat; the cards with a light edge came from simulation.

Sources: [Engineering decisions: decision log](#) and [what failed](#) · [Power and sensors: sensing bugs we fixed](#) · [Mobility: break-away](#)

5.1 Drive and power

A stopped car stayed stopped

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	At the old avoid speed of PWM 15, a car that had stopped stayed stopped until we pushed it by hand.
WHY	A stopped car needs more torque to start than to keep rolling. Our break-away test: PWM 15 does not move it from rest, PWM 18 creeps, PWM 25 always moves it.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Fix 4: avoid speed PWM 25. Whenever the commanded PWM is above 0 and below 30, the motor gets PWM 55 for the first 70 ms, then 70 ms of PWM 55 every 500 ms. Both finals sketches keep it.

Heat and a burnt component

WIRING

WHAT WE SAW	We connected a black lead near the Uno power header and got heat and a burnt component.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Motor current never returns through the Uno header; only signal ground goes to the Uno. After any wiring fault we measure the resistance from 5 V to GND with the power off before switching on again.

A simulator car 1.9 times too slow

MAT SIMULATION

WHAT WE SAW	An assumed 520 mm/s at PWM 30 predicted 40-48 s for three Open laps. The car did it in about 23 s.
WHAT WE CHANGED	We refitted the simulator to the real run: about 998 mm/s at PWM 30. Every later simulator result uses the fitted speed.

5.2 Sensing and the camera

A near pillar was thrown away

MAT SERIAL LOG

WHAT WE SAW	A serial log printed <code>area=-9646</code> for a pillar at about 30 cm, and the pillar was ignored.
WHY	A pillar filling the frame overflowed a 16-bit <code>int</code> .
WHAT WE CHANGED	The area is a <code>Long</code> .

Passing pillars on the wrong side

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	The car passed pillars on the wrong side.
WHY	Our fix notes give the likely cause: signature 1 was trained on red while the code treated 1 as green.
WHAT WE CHANGED	The code reads red as 1 and green as 2, and we train to match.

Steering on the wrong block

MAT

WHY	<code>blocks[0]</code> is the largest blob, not the nearest pillar.
WHAT WE CHANGED	The code ranges every block and steers on the nearest one within 900 mm.

Full lock into the wall (fix 13)

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	A limiter 20 cm away with a green pillar in view steered the car to full lock into the wall.
WHY	The limiter distance was written into <code>frontDist</code> , which fed the 25 cm full-lock rule. One variable served two subsystems.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Each measurement has its own variable.

The car stopped avoiding pillars (fix 25)

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	After we removed the floor on the pillar steering scale, the car stopped avoiding pillars.
WHY	A pillar clipped by the frame edge reads far away, and without a floor the turn scaled to nothing.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Back to fix 15 and its 0.35 floor. Blocks with x outside 20-300 are ignored, and the front sonar may shorten a pillar's range.

Laws that drove into the walls

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	Laws tuned in simulation for 90-degree flank sonars drove into the walls on the real car.
WHY	Our drawing of the nose (14 Sep 2026) shows the side sonars at about 40 degrees from the nose axis.
WHAT WE CHANGED	The simulator models the side units at 39 and 41 degrees, and we kept only the left-minus-right law, which does not depend on the bearing.

Corner direction was a coin toss

SIMULATION

WHY	At the 48 cm trigger both side units see the same front wall, so left minus right is close to zero. open_kuwait broke ties by turning right.
WHAT WE CHANGED	A vote of the corners already counted, plus a slow left-minus-right memory before the first corner. The vote never locks, so a wall avoided in the start zone cannot lock the wrong way. Open went from 21 to 37 successful rounds out of 40.

An early corner cue made it worse

SIMULATION

WHAT WE SAW	Starting the turn from raw side readings as the inner side opened took one batch from 22 to 5 successful rounds out of 30.
WHAT WE CHANGED	We removed it. The corner trigger stays on the front sonar.

5.3 Laps, parking and the code itself

The exit worked, but the park never armed

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	On 6 September the lot exit worked and the driving was our best so far, but the car did not park.
WHY	The build zeroed its lap counter at the handover with the car still about 50 degrees rotated. The straightening then counted as -50 degrees, lap 3 never closed, and the park never armed.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Fix 26: the turn total is never reset, the exit rotation is carried into it, and a corner counts at 70 of its 90 degrees.

Lap 3 closed at corner 13

SIMULATION

WHY	open_kuwait closed a lap at every 360 degrees.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Open counts 12 corners, then stops on the front range in the start straight, with a 700 ms backstop.

Parks that stalled (versions 14-16)

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	Parks that ended each leg on a sensor reading stalled or drove into the limiter.
WHY	Inside the bay the side units are near their 34 mm minimum and lose the echo at oblique angles, and the camera faces away from the lot.
WHAT WE CHANGED	Legs closed on the IMU heading, straight moves in measured steps, and a clearance model that checks each move before it is driven.

Ten versions in a row were worse

MAT

WHAT WE SAW	Versions 8-17 were all worse on the mat and were reverted.
WHAT WE CHANGED	No change without a named mechanism: the input, the state, the computed value and the wrong action it fixes.

Code that never ran (version 15)

CODE

WHAT WE SAW	A start-in-the-lot mode printed on the serial monitor, but its arming line was never written.
WHAT WE CHANGED	After every edit we search the file for the call site.

The car did not move (14 September)

MAT

WHY	Four causes. The start waited for a press followed by a release, so a toggle switch never started it. The exit PWM was below the break-away value of 25. The park build fitted in flash only with PlatformIO's flags (31,724 of 32,256 B), while we upload from the Arduino IDE. A BNO055 that did not answer hung the code silently in <code>while(1)</code> .
WHAT WE CHANGED	Start on any A2 change held 30 ms. One <code>.ino</code> per challenge, sized with the IDE's compiler; the v20 Obstacle sketch fits at 29,604 B with stock flags. The servo wiggles twice, repeating, when the BNO055 fails. The v20 exit keeps PWM 18, the value of the 6 September exit that worked on the mat, and we watch the first practice exits.

A build 1,674 B larger than it needed to be

BUILD

WHY	The Pixy2 Arduino library ships <code>ZumoBuzzer.cpp</code> and <code>ZumoMotors.cpp</code> . Neither sketch calls them, but they add 1,674 B of flash and 57 B of RAM to each build.
WHAT WE CHANGED	We rename both files to <code>.cpp.bak</code> . With them in place the Obstacle sketch is 31,278 B (96 %); without them, 29,604 B (91 %).

Current state and next changes

Where the car and its code stand on 15 September 2026, the problems still open, and the changes we test next.

Sources: [Engineering decisions: v20 status](#), [risks](#) and [changes we test next](#) · [src/README.md: constants to calibrate](#)

6.1 v20 status

Part	State on 15 Sep 2026	Evidence
<code>Open_Challenge.ino</code> (<code>open_v20</code>)	Frozen, <code>PRACTICE 0</code> , compiles at 15,136 B	Simulation: 36/40 on fresh seeds, 287/320 across all draw cells
<code>Obstacle_Challenge.ino</code> (<code>obstacle_v20</code>)	Frozen, <code>PRACTICE 0</code> , compiles at 29,604 B	Simulation: exit 119/120, three laps 12/120
Front-wall park	Part of the Obstacle sketch; park constants set in simulation	Simulation: 4 full parks in 16 park-only runs
<code>open_v21</code>	In development	A fixed path at each corner, a stronger direction choice, a mid-straight stop on the front sensor

6.2 Problems still open

Obstacle inner-pillar failure SIMULATION

In 23 of 24 wrong-side passes we traced, the pillar needed an inner pass: green when driving counter-clockwise, red when clockwise. Most were in the inner row, first in the straight. The mechanism is the outer-wall drift from the 40-degree sonars (section 2.3). None of these changes moved the success rate, 60 seeds each:

- an inward sweep after corners;
- earlier corner triggers at 60, 70 and 80 cm;
- engaging pillars from 1200 mm;
- faster pillar-mode entry;
- a 0.7 floor instead of 0.35;
- a stronger steering ladder;
- a bearing-offset tracking law;
- treating a silent side as long;
- disabling the fix-16 wall clamp.

Our next attempt plans the lane after each corner instead of changing another constant.

The park SIMULATION

Among 12 three-lap runs out of 120 there were 3 partial parks and 0 full parks. From the lap-3 handover pose alone, 4 of 16 parks were full, and the limiter was touched in about half. An earlier simulator model found the park succeeds only when its counter-steer leg starts inside a window about 37 mm wide, while open-loop positioning scattered with a standard deviation of about 24 mm. That is why v20 measures its step length and solves the entry angle from the real stop pose.

6.3 Before every official round

- ☐ `PRACTICE` is 0 in the uploaded sketch. With 0 the car stays still after power-up until A2 changes.
- ☐ Pixy2 trained in PixyMon under the venue light: signature 1 red, 2 green, 3 magenta.
- ☐ Obstacle car placed about 40 mm from the outer wall, the same gap every attempt.
- ☐ On the bench, turn the car clockwise by hand: `yaw` in the `WAIT` line rises.
- ☐ Both batteries charged; voltages written on the test sheet.

6.4 Changes we test next

Each candidate names the mechanism it addresses before we write any code.

Candidate	Mechanism it addresses	Test before it ships
BNO055 in IMUPLUS mode, <code>bno.begin(OPERATION_MODE_IMUPLUS)</code>	A magnetic field moving the NDOF heading and counting a phantom corner	Heading drift over 3 minutes standing, and 12-corner counts, in both modes
Corner-exit lane plan for Obstacle, from the lap-1 map or the camera during the turn	Outer-wall drift puts the first pillar outside the camera view	60 lot-start seeds against v20, then practice runs
Rear-facing HC-SR04 on two free pins (TRIG and ECHO from D6, A1, A3)	The park's reverse leg is dead-reckoned into a 37 mm window	Park-only runs in simulation, then on the mat

6.5 Risks and what we do about them

Risk	What we would see	Mitigation
<code>PRACTICE 1</code> in an official round	Car moves 3 s after power-up, breaking rule 9.11	<code>src/</code> has <code>PRACTICE 0</code> ; bench check before every round
Start input does not reach A2	Car never starts with <code>PRACTICE 0</code>	Bench check step 8: change the switch and watch the car respond
BNO055 not answering	Servo wiggles twice, repeating	Visible fault code instead of a silent hang
NDOF magnetometer moves the heading	Phantom or missed corner	20 degrees of margin in the corner count; IMUPLUS mode is a change we test next
Exit creeps at PWM 18, below the 25 break-away value	Car stalls in the lot	Same values as the 6 September exit that worked on the mat; we watch the first practice exits
Wrong outer-wall pick	Car exits the wrong way	Place the car about 40 mm from the outer wall; check the printout
Inner sonar silent in a 1000 mm corridor	Car rides off the outer wall and misses the next pillar	A corner-exit lane plan is a change we test next
Park constants set in simulation	Park too shallow, too deep or touching a limiter	The car measures its own step length and closes every arc on the IMU; the mat procedures in chapter 4 set the constants in practice time
Park window missed	Car would start lap 4	Stops at the next corner in the start section
Obstacle v20 drives worse than our earlier build in practice	Wrong direction or pillar hits	If it drives the wrong way or hits pillars twice in practice, we switch to the earlier build
Pixy2 range constants off for our lens	Pillars engage at the wrong distance	Width check in PixyMon: a pillar 500 mm straight ahead reads about 27 px wide
Battery 1 charge changes speed	Timed moves behave differently on a flat motor battery	Arcs closed on the IMU, steps measured before use; battery 1 voltage written down before every session
Battery 2 runs flat	The Uno resets mid-round; <code>setup()</code> sets the motor to 0 and waits for a new start input	Battery 2 voltage written down before every session (bench check step 10)
Flash near the limit	A new feature does not fit	Size checked with the IDE compiler before upload
Motor battery negative through the Uno header	Heat, burnt parts	Motor current kept on battery 1 and off the Uno header; 5 V to GND checked with power off after a fault

Appendix: pin map and system overview

The pins are identical in both sketches: `Open_Challenge.ino` lines 30-35 and `Obstacle_Challenge.ino` lines 51-56.

Sources: [Build, test and reproduce: wiring](#) · [src/README.md: pin map](#)

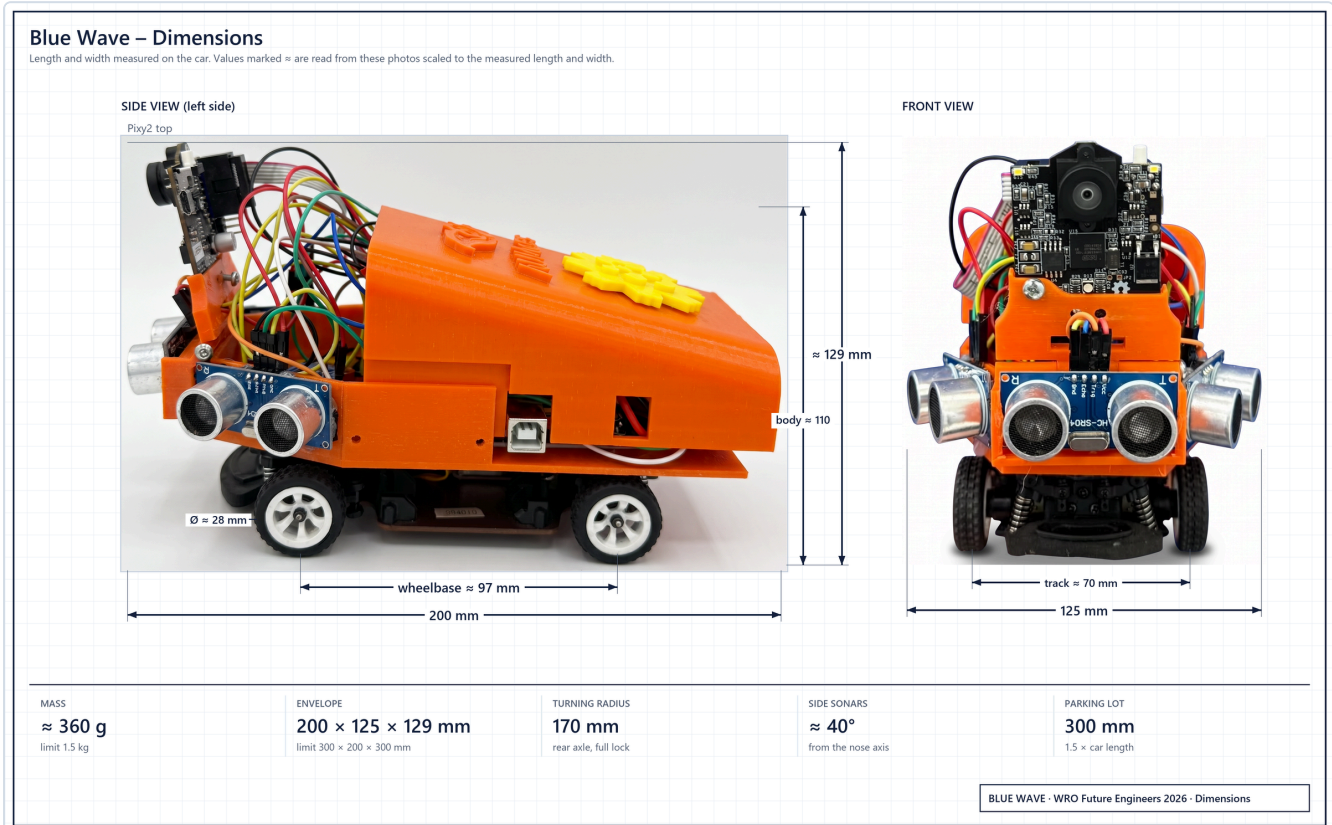


Figure 8. Dimensions. Length and width measured on the car; the other values are read from the photos scaled to those two measurements. Mass is the estimate from the mass budget in [docs/01-mobility.md](#).

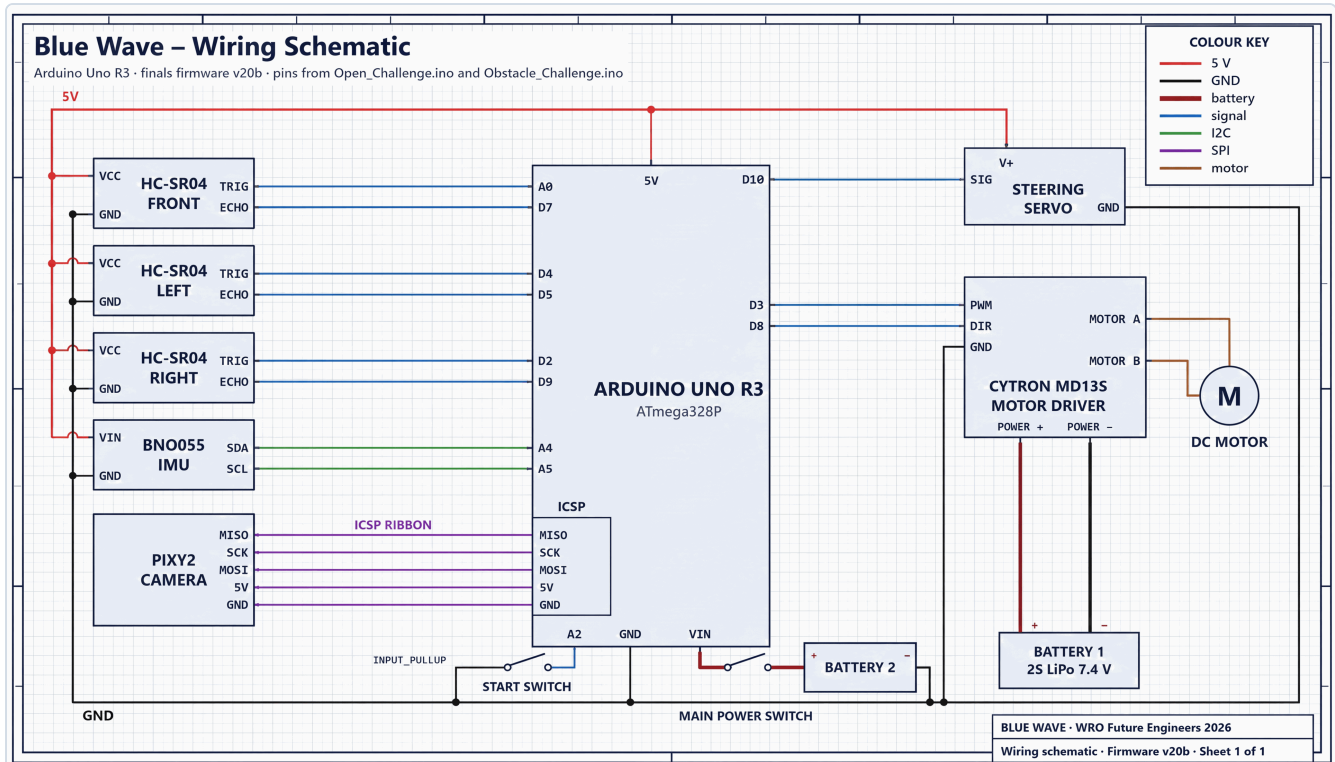
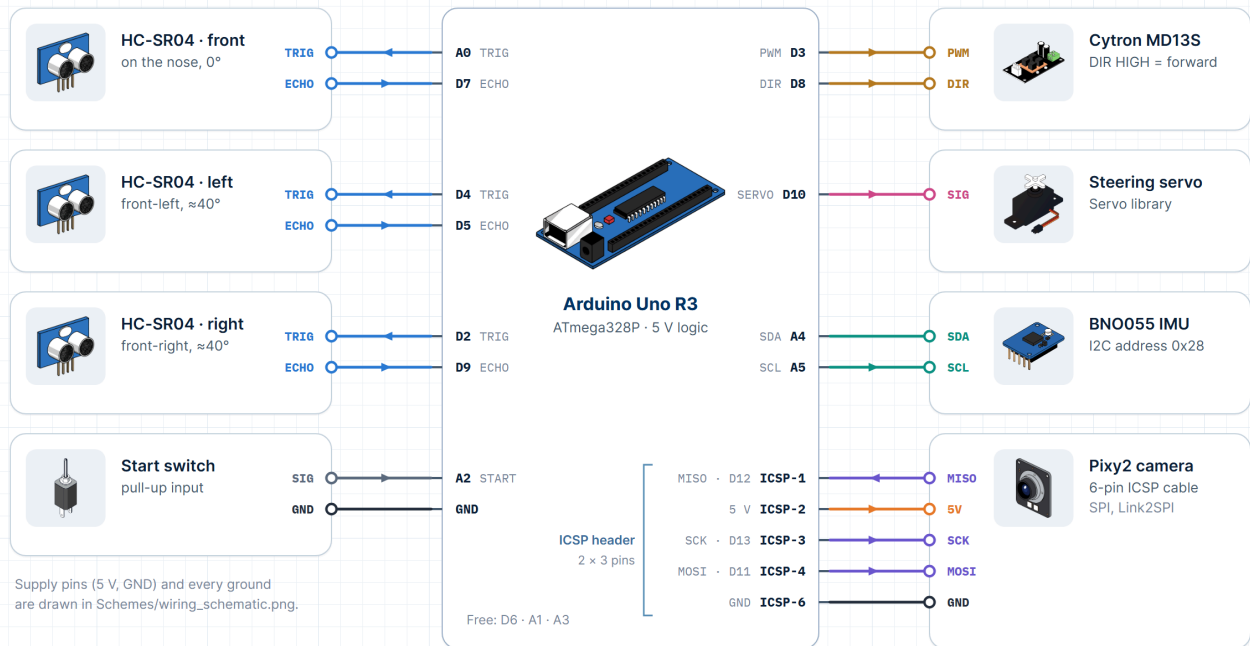


Figure 9. Wiring schematic. Every signal, supply and ground wire of the car on one sheet. A hop marks two wires that cross without connecting; a dot marks a junction. Editable source: [Schemes/wiring_schematic_source.svg](#).

Wiring pin map

Signal wires between the Arduino Uno R3 and every part, exactly as set in the v20 finals firmware.



WIRES — Sonar trig / echo — Digital input — Motor PWM + DIR — Servo PWM — I2C — SPI — 5 V — GND — signal direction

PIN TABLE

open = Open_Challenge.ino, obstacle = Obstacle_Challenge.ino (line numbers)

Part	Signal	Arduino pin	Mode / library	Defined in (line)
● HC-SR04 front	TRIG / ECHO	A0 / D7	NewPing, max 400 cm	open 32 · obstacle 53
● HC-SR04 left	TRIG / ECHO	D4 / D5	NewPing, max 400 cm	open 30 · obstacle 51
● HC-SR04 right	TRIG / ECHO	D2 / D9	NewPing, max 400 cm	open 31 · obstacle 52
● Steering servo	signal	D10	Servo library	open 33 · obstacle 54
● Cytron MD13S	PWM / DIR	D3 / D8	analogWrite / digitalWrite, DIR HIGH = forward	open 34 · obstacle 55
● Start switch	to GND	A2	INPUT_PULLUP, a change held 30 ms starts	open 35 · obstacle 56
● BNO055 IMU	SDA / SCL	A4 / A5	I2C (Wire), address 0x28, 25 ms timeout	open 125 · obstacle 297
● Pixy2 camera	MISO / MOSI / SCK	ICSP (D12 / D11 / D13)	SPI, Link2SPI; 5 V and GND on ICSP	Pixy2.h 64
● Serial debug	RX / TX	D0 / D1	115200 baud	open 124 · obstacle 296

Pins: Open_Challenge.ino / Obstacle_Challenge.ino · component art: generic illustrations

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Wiring pin map

Figure 10. Wiring pin map. Signal wires between the Arduino Uno R3 and every part, as set in the v20 finals firmware. The supply side is in the power paths figure in section 2.6.

Part	Signal	Uno pin	Code object and mode
HC-SR04, left front corner	TRIG / ECHO	D4 / D5	<code>sonarLeft</code> , NewPing, 400 cm limit
HC-SR04, right front corner	TRIG / ECHO	D2 / D9	<code>sonarRight</code> , NewPing
HC-SR04, nose	TRIG / ECHO	A0 / D7	<code>sonarFront</code> , NewPing
Steering servo	Signal	D10	<code>steeringServo</code> , Servo library
Cytron MD13S	PWM / DIR	D3 / D8	<code>runMotor()</code> ; DIR HIGH = forward
Start switch, other side to GND	Input	A2	<code>waitStart()</code> , <code>INPUT_PULLUP</code> ; a change held 30 ms starts
BNO055 IMU	SDA / SCL	A4 / A5	<code>bn0</code> , I2C address 0x28, 25 ms bus timeout with reset
Pixy2 camera	SPI	ICSP: MOSI D11, MISO D12, SCK D13	<code>pixy</code> , Link2SPI; 5 V and GND on the ICSP header
USB serial	RX / TX	D0 / D1	Debug print, 115200 baud
Free	-	D6, A1, A3	-

Steering convention for every law: above 90 steers left, below 90 steers right. The lap laws stay within 30-160; the Obstacle lot exit and park use full lock at 10 (right) and 170 (left). The Servo library takes Timer1, which removes PWM from D9 and D10, so D9 is only an echo input and the motor PWM is on D3. The motor PWM is on D3.

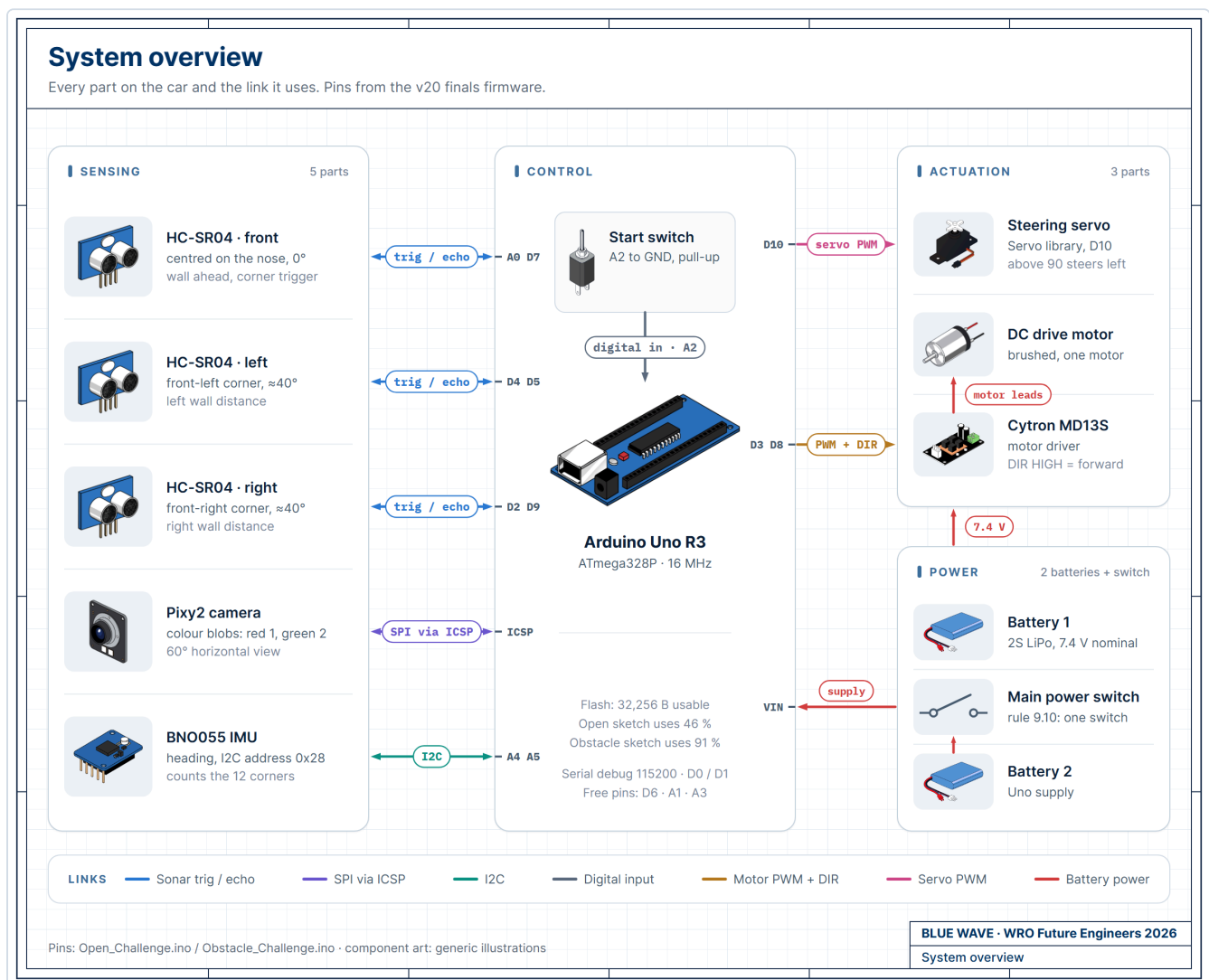


Figure 11. System overview. Every part on the car and the link it uses, with the pins from the v20 finals firmware. Battery 1 feeds the MD13S; battery 2 feeds the Uno's VIN through the main power switch.

Appendix: parts list and software versions

Everything needed to build the car and to compile the two sketches to the same sizes.

Sources: [Build, test and reproduce: bill of materials](#), [software versions](#) and [expected sizes](#)

B.1 Parts list

Qty	Part	Job	Connection
1	Arduino Uno R3 (ATmega328P, 16 MHz)	Runs one challenge sketch at a time	USB for upload and serial; VIN from battery 2
1	Cytron MD13S motor driver	Drives the motor from PWM and direction	PWM D3, DIR D8; power input from battery 1
1	Brushed DC drive motor	Propulsion through the chassis gearbox	MD13S output
1	Hobby steering servo	Ackermann steering	Signal D10
1	WLtoys 1:28-class RC chassis with wheels, gearbox and steering linkage	Frame and drivetrain	-
3	HC-SR04 ultrasonic sensor	Front, left and right distance	A0/D7, D4/D5, D2/D9; 5 V from the Uno
1	Pixy2 camera	Pillar colour, bearing and range	ICSP header (SPI and 5 V)
1	BNO055 IMU breakout	Heading	A4 (SDA), A5 (SCL); 5 V from the Uno
1	Battery 1: 2S LiPo, 7.4 V nominal	Powers only the drive motor	Straight to the MD13S power input
1	Battery 2	Powers the Uno; the Uno's regulator makes 5 V for the sensors and the Pixy2	Main power switch, then the Uno's VIN
1	Main power switch	Rule 9.10: one switch turns the car on	Between battery 2 and the Uno's VIN
1	Start switch or push button	Rule 9.11: one start button	A2 to GND
1 set	Printed body and sensor brackets	Mounting	Models/BlueWave_main_body_v2.3mf : main body, two ultrasonic brackets, one ultrasonic and Pixy2 bracket, one Pixy2 bracket

B.2 Software versions

Item	Version
Arduino IDE	2.3.10 (bundled <code>arduino-cli</code> 1.5.1)
Arduino AVR Boards core	1.8.8, board <code>arduino:avr:uno</code>
Servo	1.3.0
Wire	Bundled with the core
Adafruit BNO055	1.6.4
Adafruit Unified Sensor	1.1.15
Adafruit BusIO	1.17.4
NewPing	1.9.7
Pixy2	Arduino library from pixycam.com, installed by hand

Installed on our development PC on 15 September 2026. The upload laptop must have the same versions; bench check step 1 compares them.

B.4 Expected sizes BUILD

Build	Open_Challenge.ino	Obstacle_Challenge.ino
Stock compiler flags, Zumo files renamed	15,136 B (46 %), RAM 721 B	29,604 B (91 %), RAM 818 B
Stock compiler flags, Pixy2 library as downloaded	16,810 B (52 %), RAM 778 B	31,278 B (96 %), RAM 875 B
Our PC's extra flags, Zumo files renamed	14,630 B (45 %), RAM 721 B	28,682 B (88 %), RAM 818 B

Compiled on 15 Sep 2026 with the IDE's own `arduino-cli` 1.5.1 and AVR core 1.8.8, from the files in `src/`, each with a fresh build folder, out of 32,256 B of flash. Our development PC also has a `platform.local.txt` that adds `-mcall-prologues -mrelax`; neither sketch needs it. If a build reports a different size on another PC, check the Zumo files and this file first.

B.3 Build steps

1. In the Boards Manager install *Arduino AVR Boards* 1.8.8 and select *Arduino Uno*.
2. In the Library Manager install the versions in the table. Copy the Pixy2 library into `Documents/Arduino/libraries/`, then rename `ZumoBuzzer.cpp` and `ZumoMotors.cpp` to `.cpp.bak`.
3. Open `src/Open_Challenge/Open_Challenge.ino` or `src/Obstacle_Challenge/Obstacle_Challenge.ino`.
4. Check that line 36 (Open) or line 62 (Obstacle) reads `#define PRACTICE 0`.
5. Verify: the output must match the sizes below.
6. Connect the Uno over USB, select its port, press *Upload*.
7. Train the Pixy2 signatures in PixyMon, then run the bench check.